Northwind Traders

Sales Performance Analysis Report

Prepared for Management | November 2026

Executive Summary

Northwind Traders generated approximately $1.35 million in total revenue across the analyzed period. Revenue is moderately concentrated, with the top 10 customers contributing roughly 45% of total sales. Three customers — QUICK-Stop, Save-a-lot Markets, and Ernst Handel — each generate over $113,000 in revenue and place frequent high-value orders (average order values of $3,700–$4,200).

Product performance is also concentrated. Côte de Blaye alone generated nearly $150,000 in revenue, while several products (including Chocolade, Geitost, and Genen Shouyu) contributed less than $2,000 each. Employee performance varies significantly, with Margaret Peacock generating over $250,000 compared to the lowest performer at approximately $76,000.

Monthly sales show a clear upward trend from mid-1996 through early 1998, peaking above $130,000 in April 1998. The business faces both a clear growth opportunity through deeper engagement with high-value customers and a concentration risk if any of the top three accounts are lost.

Key Findings

Top 10 Customers by Revenue

Rank	Customer	Revenue	% of Total
1	QUICK-Stop	$117,483	8.67%
2	Save-a-lot Markets	$115,673	8.54%
3	Ernst Handel	$113,237	8.36%
4	Hungry Owl All-Night Grocers	$57,317	4.23%
5	Rattlesnake Canyon Grocery	$52,246	3.86%
6	Hanari Carnes	$34,101	2.52%
7	Folk och fä HB	$32,556	2.40%
8	Mère Paillarde	$32,204	2.38%
9	Königlich Essen	$31,746	2.34%
10	Queen Cozinha	$30,226	2.23%

The top 10 customers account for approximately 45.5% of total revenue. The top 3 alone represent over 25%.

Top Products by Revenue

Product	Revenue
Côte de Blaye	$149,984

Thüringer Rostbratwurst	$87,736
Raclette Courdavault	$76,296
Camembert Pierrot	$50,286
Tarte au sucre	$49,828

Several products generate less than $2,000 in total revenue and may warrant review for discontinuation or promotion.

Employee Sales Performance

Employee	Revenue
Margaret Peacock	$250,187
Janet Leverling	$213,051
Nancy Davolio	$202,144
Andrew Fuller	$177,749
Robert King	$141,296
Laura Callahan	$133,301
Anne Dodsworth	$82,964
Michael Suyama	$78,198
Steven Buchanan	$75,568

The top performer generates more than 3× the revenue of the lowest performer, indicating a significant performance gap.

Order Patterns – High-Value Customers

Customer	Orders	Total Revenue	Avg Order Value
QUICK-Stop	28	$117,483	$4,196
Ernst Handel	30	$113,237	$3,775
Save-a-lot Markets	31	$115,673	$3,731
Hungry Owl All-Night Grocers	19	$57,317	$3,017
Rattlesnake Canyon Grocery	18	$52,246	$2,903

Recommendations

1. Protect and Grow Top Accounts
Develop formal account management plans for QUICK-Stop, Save-a-lot Markets, and Ernst Handel. These three customers represent over 25% of revenue. Regular check-ins, priority fulfillment, and volume incentives can strengthen retention.

2. Review Low-Performing Products
Products generating less than $2,000 in lifetime revenue (e.g., Chocolade, Geitost, Genen Shouyu) should be evaluated for discontinuation, re-pricing, or targeted promotion. Inventory tied up in these SKUs represents opportunity cost.

3. Address Employee Performance Gap
Investigate the practices of top performers (Margaret Peacock, Janet Leverling, Nancy Davolio). Consider

territory realignment, coaching, or best-practice sharing to raise the performance of lower-producing employees.

4. Monitor Concentration Risk
While the top customers are valuable, high concentration creates risk. Actively develop mid-tier customers (ranks 11–30) to reduce dependency on any single account.

Report generated from Northwind Traders dataset analysis. All figures based on order line revenue (quantity × unit price).